COMMONWEALTH OF VIRGINIA

PETITION FOR PATIENT PROTECTION AND INDEPENDENT ACCOUNTABILITY

WESTERN STATE HOSPITAL | STAFF PETITION

TO: Governor of Virginia; Attorney General of Virginia; State Inspector General; and Virginia General Assembly committees responsible for behavioral health and government oversight.

We, the undersigned employees and supporters, request a fair, independent review of patient safety and staff accountability at Western State Hospital. Employees should be able to report suspected abuse, retaliation, neglect, or failures to report without fear of punishment. This petition does not presume wrongdoing by any employee.

Requested action

- An independent investigation and periodic audit of complaints, abuse reports, retaliation allegations, and reporting practices.
- Legally authorized employee integrity screening, including polygraph examinations when appropriate and lawful, with due process and employment-law safeguards.
- Review of three subjects: (1) patient abuse or mistreatment; (2) retaliation for complaints; and (3) witnessing, concealing, or failing to report serious misconduct.
- Confidential reporting outside hospital management, protection against retaliation, timely written complaint responses, and referrals when evidence supports disciplinary or criminal action.
- A written response explaining what action the Commonwealth will take and whether legislation or policy changes are needed.

Reason for this request

Virginia Department of Corrections Operating Procedure 030.4 provides for authorized polygraph examinations in certain investigations. We request comparable attention to patient safety at state psychiatric hospitals—not an assertion that every corrections employee is already required to undergo testing. Patient rights are also protected by Virginia Code § 37.2-400 and 12VAC35-115. A polygraph alone is not proof of misconduct; independent evidence and fair procedures remain essential.

No patient or employee should be pressured to sign or punished for signing or declining to sign. Please protect the confidentiality of signers and avoid disclosure of patient treatment information.

Petition organizer: adam nicholas: casey Date: _____

STAFF PETITION — SIGNATURE SHEET

I support the request for independent patient protections, investigation, and fair accountability. My signature does not accuse any particular person of wrongdoing.

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Signing is voluntary. Please do not include patient diagnoses, treatment details, or other private medical information on this sheet.